Who Do You Say I Am?

Luke 2:52 · John 11 · Philippians 2:5–11 · Matthew 16:13–17:8

The big idea: Jesus is truly man as well as truly God. He grew, got tired and hungry, and wept, yet without sin. He is one Person with two natures. Only someone who is both could save us. And he asks each of us, "Who do you say that I am?"

Before you meet: Read

John 11:32–44 | Philippians 2:5–11 | Matthew 16:13–17 | Matthew 17:1–8

Open (5 minutes)

When have you felt that someone truly understood what you were going through?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"You are the _____, the Son of the living God." *(Matthew 16:16)*

"Jesus _____." *(John 11:35)*

Discuss

1. Jesus got tired, hungry, and wept. How does his full humanity change the way you pray to him? *John 4:6; 11:35; Hebrews 4:15*

2. Jesus asked, Who do you say that I am? What is your honest answer today? *Matthew 16:15–17; John 20:31*

3. Peter's confession was a gift from the Father. What does that mean for the people you are praying for? *Matthew 16:17*

Memory verse

> *"For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who in every respect has been tempted as we are, yet without sin."*
>
> **Hebrews 4:15**

Pray

Thank God that he came to us himself in his Son. Worship Jesus as truly God, and thank him that as truly man he knows your weakness. Ask the Father to show you who Jesus really is, as he showed Peter.

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Who Do You Say I Am?

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Philippians 2:5–11 and Matthew 16:13–17 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Mark 1–2 and Matthew 5).

Main points to land

1. Jesus is truly man: he grew, tired, hungered, and wept, yet without sin. One Person, two natures, without conversion, composition, or confusion (WCF 8.2).
2. Only one who is both God and man could save us: truly man to stand in our place, truly God to give his death infinite worth (Heb. 2:17; 1 Tim. 2:5).
3. He came to seek and save the lost and to give his life as a ransom. Each of us must answer his question: who do you say that I am? (Luke 19:10; Mark 10:45; Matthew 16:15).

Core doctrine to teach

Jesus: Truly God and Truly Man CORE DOCTRINE 19 OF 26

Jesus Christ is one person with two natures. He is fully God, the eternal Son, and fully man, with a real body and soul. The two natures are not mixed or divided. He became one of us without ceasing to be God, so that he could stand in our place. *John 1:1, 14; Colossians 2:9; Hebrews 2:14–17; Philippians 2:5–8*

Answer key (Observe)

1. Christ
2. wept

Questions people will ask

Wasn't Jesus just a good moral teacher?

A merely good teacher does not forgive other people's sins against God, claim God's name, accept worship, or say that seeing him is seeing God. His hearers understood him and tried to stone him for blasphemy (John 10:33). Either his claims are false, or he is who he said he is.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you for sending your Son, the Word made flesh, Immanuel, God with us. Open our eyes, as you opened Peter's, to see who Jesus really is. Help us worship him as truly God and trust him as truly man, our merciful High Priest. May each of us answer his question with Thomas: my Lord and my God. Amen.